

1825 ▶ 1835

1826

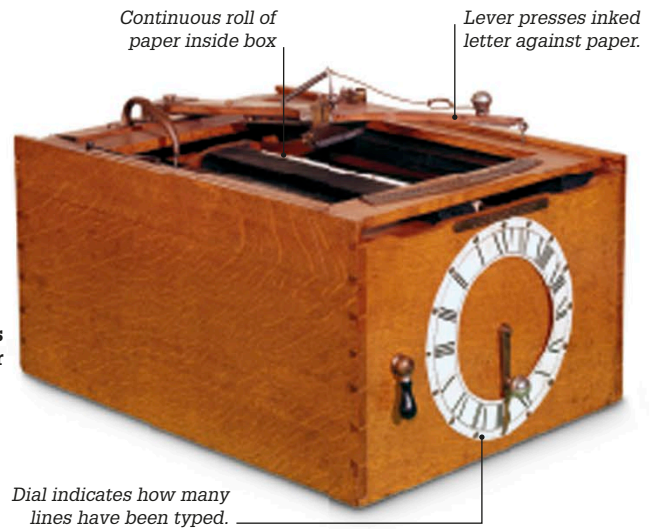
First photograph

Joseph Nicéphore Niépce, a French inventor, took the world's oldest surviving photograph. He fixed a metal plate to the back wall of a camera obscura (see p.66) and used it to capture the view from his window. The plate, made of pewter, was thinly coated with bitumen (a light-sensitive, tarlike material). The exposure took several hours.



Niépce's *View from the Window at Le Gras*

Replica of Burt's typographer



Dial indicates how many lines have been typed.

Continuous roll of paper inside box

Lever presses inked letter against paper.

“The objects appear with astonishing sharpness... down to the smallest details.”

Niépce describing photography in a letter to his brother

1829

First typewriter

American inventor William Burt patented what is regarded as the world's first typewriter. He called it a typographer. It was quite clumsy to use—writing a letter on it took longer than writing the letter by hand.



1825

1825

Wipe out!

French naturalist Georges Cuvier proposed that Earth had suffered some major catastrophes, which had wiped out large groups of animals. This idea, explaining the existence of fossils that belonged to unknown species, was known as catastrophism.

1828

Animal attractions

The London Zoological Society opened a zoological garden in Regent's Park, London, as a place for the scientific study of animals. Originally only Fellows (members) of the society could make use of it. However, when London Zoo opened its gates to the public in 1847, it became a popular tourist attraction.

Victorian visitors to London Zoo feeding the elephants, 1896

